A SHORT GUIDE FROM RTB GYM, WINDSOR AND CHELSEA HEIGHTS

WHY THE FITNESS INDUSTRY IS DITCHING CARDIO FOR WEIGHT TRAINING

And what it means for your body, your energy and the next 20 years of your life.

BY JOSH CURRY, EXERCISE SCIENTIST AND HEAD COACH. AN 8 MINUTE READ.



I DID EVERYTHING THE FITNESS INDUSTRY TOLD ME. IT DID NOT WORK.

I am an exercise scientist. For years I did what the textbooks and the magazines said. Run, cycle, sweat, eat less. I was tired, I was sore, and the mirror barely moved. The photo on the cover is me, before and after. The difference was not more effort. It was a different direction.

When I stopped chasing calories on a treadmill and started lifting with a plan, three things happened. I got leaner without starving. I got stronger every single week and could see it in an app. And I stopped dreading training, because every session finally had a point.

I opened RTB to give people that same switch. No cardio. No random workouts. A full body strength program, coached every set, in a room capped at 12 people. This guide is the why behind it. Read it, then decide if it is for you.

Josh Curry
Head Coach and Owner, RTB Gym



Josh Curry, Head Coach. RTB Windsor.

100+
five star Google reviews across our two gyms

MUSCLE IS THE ORGAN THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING.

Cardio burns calories while you do it. Muscle burns them all day, protects your joints and bones, and is the best single predictor of how well you age. Here is what happens when you train for strength instead of sweat.

7%

higher resting metabolism after 10 weeks of strength training, with 1.4 kg more muscle and 1.8 kg less fat [1]

17%

lower risk of early death in adults who do regular muscle strengthening exercise [2]

8%

of your muscle can disappear every decade after 30 if you do nothing to keep it [3]

0 min

of cardio needed to lose fat. Strength training on its own reduces body fat and the deep fat around your organs [4]

	CARDIO	STRENGTH TRAINING
Calories burned	During the session	During, and for up to 48 hours after
Muscle	Lost or unchanged	Built
Metabolism	Drops as you lose weight	Rises as you build muscle
Bones and joints	Repetitive impact	Stronger bones, protected joints
Proof it is working	Minutes on a clock	Kilos on the bar, every session
Time it takes	45 to 60 minutes, most days	50 minutes, three times a week

Sources are listed on the last page.

THE DECADE THAT DECIDES HOW YOUR 40S FEEL.

From 30 your body quietly starts trading muscle for fat. Not because you are doing something wrong. Because that is what happens when muscle is not asked to work. Lifting flips it.

1. **LEAN, NOT SKINNY**
   Muscle gives you shape. Cardio and under eating give you a smaller version of the same body. Strength builds the arms, glutes and posture that clothes actually hang off.

2. **A METABOLISM THAT WORKS FOR YOU**
   Every kilo of muscle you build burns energy around the clock. You eat like a normal person and still lean out.

3. **ENERGY FOR THE STUFF THAT MATTERS**
   Strong women do not run out of steam at 3pm. Kids, groceries and a full calendar get easier when you lift.

4. **A BODY THAT HOLDS UP**
   Lifting now builds the bone and joint strength that protects you later. The best time to bank it is this decade.

5. **CONFIDENCE YOU CAN MEASURE**
   The first time you deadlift your bodyweight you stop thinking about what your body looks like and start thinking about what it can do.



Strong is the look.

> “I joined with absolutely no experience in weightlifting, and now I’m here 4 to 5 times a week.”
>
> Lauren, RTB Windsor

THE STRONGEST ANSWER TO MENOPAUSE IS A BARBELL.

Falling oestrogen pulls muscle and bone off you and pushes fat to your middle. Cardio does not stop it. Progressive strength training is the one thing shown to push back on all of it.

1. **STRONGER BONES**
   Eight months of heavy, coached lifting improved bone density in postmenopausal women with low bone mass, safely. Walking did not.

2. **LESS BELLY FAT**
   Strength training reduces visceral fat, the deep fat around the organs that menopause piles on.

3. **BETTER SLEEP, BETTER MOOD**
   Resistance training improves sleep quality and reduces symptoms of depression. Most members notice both inside the first month.

4. **FEWER ACHES**
   Strong muscles take the load off knees, hips and backs. Members in their 50s tell us the stiffness goes first.

5. **INDEPENDENCE, DECADES OUT**
   Grip strength predicts how long and how well you will live better than your blood pressure does. You build it one lift at a time.



Every lift has a version for you.

> **“Josh and his team have helped me, a 42 year old mum of 2, achieve things I never thought possible. Like deadlift 140 kg!”**
>
> Kellie, RTB Windsor

GET YOUR EDGE BACK. KEEP IT FOR 30 YEARS.

Testosterone drifts down about 1% a year from 30. Muscle follows it, the gut grows, the back starts complaining. Running does not fix any of that. Lifting heavy, with a plan, does.

1. **LOSE THE GUT WITHOUT LIVING ON A TREADMILL**
   Men who strength train regularly cut their type 2 diabetes risk by a third. Muscle is where carbs go when you have enough of it.

2. **STRENGTH YOU CAN FEEL EVERY WEEK**
   The bar goes up every session and the app shows it. Most men add more to their lifts in 16 weeks here than in years of gym memberships.

3. **A BACK THAT STOPS COMPLAINING**
   Strength training is one of the most effective treatments for chronic low back pain. Strong glutes and a strong trunk do what a foam roller cannot.

4. **KEEP UP WITH THE KIDS**
   Muscle is reaction time, balance and power. Build it now and you are the dad still playing in 20 years.

5. **TESTOSTERONE, THE NATURAL WAY**
   Heavy compound lifts, enough sleep and enough protein are the three levers you actually control. We coach all three.



Coached by people who lift.

> “After years (decades) of misadventures with my aspirations for fitness, I have found my nirvana.”
>
> Paul, RTB Windsor

CHEST DAY IS DEAD. HERE IS WHAT REPLACED IT.

The old way: chest Monday, back Tuesday, legs Wednesday, arms Thursday. Miss a day and that muscle waits a week. At RTB every session trains your whole body, built around one big lift a day.

1 YOU RECOVER FASTER

The work is spread across your whole body, so no single muscle gets flogged for an hour. You walk out tired, not wrecked, and you are back in two days.

2 YOU LIFT MORE, SO YOU GET STRONGER

You practise the big lifts three times a week instead of once. More quality reps at higher loads is how strength is actually built.

3 IT IS FOOLPROOF WHEN LIFE GETS IN THE WAY

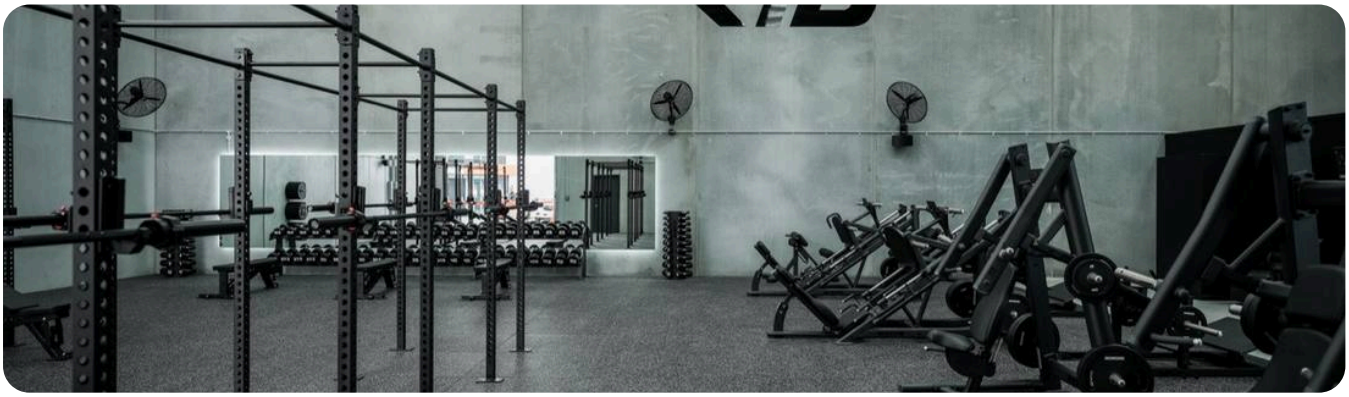
Miss Tuesday? You still trained everything on Monday and you will again on Thursday. Nothing gets skipped for a week.

4 THE RESEARCH AGREES

Training each muscle three times a week produced more muscle growth than once a week, with exactly the same total work.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
Bench	Deadlift	Incline	Squat	Catch up

One main lift a day, full body every day. Same program at both gyms, so you can train wherever you are.



RTB Windsor. One main lift a day, full body every day.

YOU NEVER GUESS. YOU NEVER PLATEAU.
YOU NEVER TRAIN ALONE.

EVERY SET COACHED
A coach watches every set, fixes your form before it hurts and loads the bar when you are ready. No googling exercises. No wondering if you are doing it right.

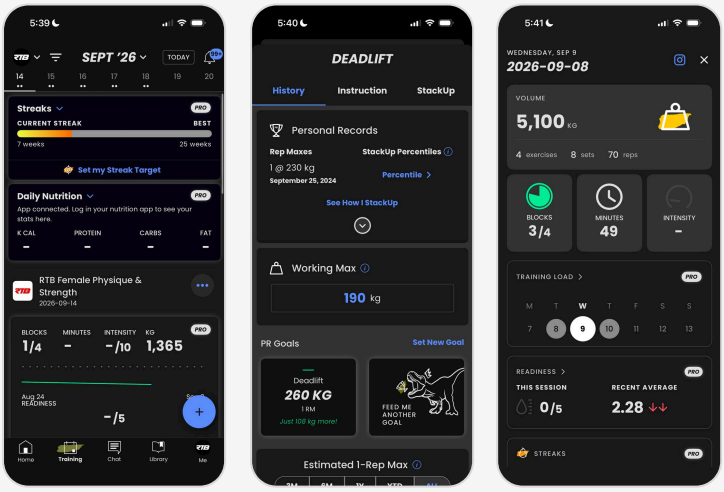
PROGRESS YOU CAN SEE
Every rep is logged in the RTB app. Working max, personal records, streaks. The numbers go up and you watch it happen.

PROOF ON THE SCANNER
The Evolt 360 body scanner shows muscle gained and fat lost in kilos, by body part. No more guessing from the mirror.

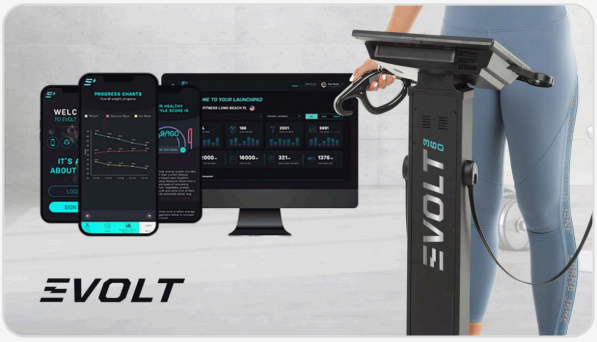
50 MINUTES, DONE
In, coached, out. Three sessions a week. Capped at 12 so nobody waits for a rack.

A ROOM THAT WANTS YOU THERE
Mums, tradies, teachers, retirees. Nobody is judged, everyone is on their own numbers, and the group notices when you go missing.

RECOVERY BUILT IN
Saunas and an ice bath at Chelsea Heights, free for members, after every session.



The RTB app. Every lift, every record, every streak.



The Evolt 360. Muscle and fat, in kilos, by body part.

HERE IS WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS.

DAY 1

YOUR CALL

15 minutes with a coach. Where your body is, where you want it to be, and the plan to get there. No pressure and no sales script.

WEEK 1

LEARN THE LIFTS

Squat, deadlift, bench, press. Coached from the very first rep. You will be surprised how fast it clicks.

WEEK 2

THE NUMBERS MOVE

The weight on the bar goes up every session. Sleep improves. The 3pm slump disappears.

WEEK 3

YOU LOOK DIFFERENT

Clothes fit differently. Your posture changes. People start asking what you are doing.



Coached from the first rep.

THEN IT COMPOUNDS

THE 21 DAY RESET
builds momentum.

THE 16 WEEK PROGRAM
turns it into a routine.

THE ROUTINE
is what changes your life.

No lock in. No obligation to continue. If it is not for you, you walk away stronger than you came.

EXPERTS WHO ACTUALLY WATCH YOU LIFT.

Every RTB coach is qualified, trained in the RTB system and on the floor for every set. They are the reason the Google reviews say the same things over and over: knowledgeable, patient, welcoming.

WINDSOR

Alison · Ryan · Stefan · Brett · Marcus

CHELSEA HEIGHTS

Sam · Marcus · Brett · Hanz

Josh Curry
Head Coach and Owner, Exercise Scientist

Liz Domenico
Nutrition Coach



Coaches on the floor, RTB Windsor.

> "I feel like I have my own PT, even in a group. Alison, Ryan, Stefan are the best."
>
> N B, RTB Windsor

> "Being an osteopath in the local area I struggled to find knowledgeable PTs. Since RTB opened I have sent all my patients to Josh and the coaches."
>
> Patrick, osteopath, Chelsea Heights

EAT SO THE RESULTS ACTUALLY SHOW.



Liz Domenico, Nutrition Coach.

Training builds the muscle. Food decides whether you see it. Liz Domenico is RTB's nutrition coach and a lifter herself, so there are no meal plans you cannot stick to and no cutting out whole food groups.

Protein targets, a simple structure, and real meals that fit a busy week. Members who add Liz's coaching to their training are the ones whose photos end up on the next pages.

1. **PROTEIN FIRST**
   1.6 to 2.2 grams per kilo of bodyweight, every day. It is the one number that matters most.
2. **EAT ENOUGH TO TRAIN HARD**
   Under eating is why cardio people stay soft. Muscle needs fuel to grow.
3. **WEEKENDS ARE PLANNED, NOT PUNISHED**
   Dinners out and a glass of wine fit in a plan that expects them.

Liz Domenico
Nutrition Coach, RTB Gym

REAL PEOPLE. REAL NUMBERS.



DEANNE, CHELSEA HEIGHTS

Started in menopause, wanting to find herself again. Deadlift from 20 kg to 100 kg in under a year. Her words: strong is the new goal.



THE RUGBY DADS, CHELSEA HEIGHTS

Three ex rugby dads who joined for their kids. Daley went from 135 kg to 110 kg and is now the strongest man in the gym.

8 kg
lost in 2 months
Melissa, Chelsea Heights

10 kg
lost training twice a week
Vyvyan, Windsor

140 kg
deadlift at 42, mum of two
Kellie, Windsor

3 weeks
to visible results
Brendan, Windsor

EVERY REASON NOT TO START, ANSWERED.

1. **"I AM NOT FIT ENOUGH FOR A GYM LIKE THIS."**
   Nobody is when they start. Most members had never lifted. Classes are capped at 12 and the coach sets your weights, not the person next to you.

2. **"I WILL GET BULKY."**
   Building noticeable muscle takes years of deliberate eating and training. What you get in 21 days is firmer, leaner and stronger. Bulky is never an accident.

3. **"I DO NOT HAVE TIME."**
   Three 50 minute sessions a week. Less time than most people spend on cardio that does not work. Classes from 5am, through the day and into the evening at both gyms.

4. **"I HAVE A DODGY BACK, KNEE OR SHOULDER."**
   Tell the coach. Every lift has a version for you. Local osteopaths send their patients to us for exactly this reason.

5. **"I HAVE TRIED GYMS BEFORE AND QUIT."**
   You quit because nobody noticed and nothing changed. Here the coach knows your name and your numbers, and the group messages you when you go missing.

6. **"I WILL NOT KEEP IT UP."**
   That is what the 21 days are for. You do not need motivation. You need a start date and a coach.



Josh. Still laughing at the treadmill years.

WHAT ZERO CARDIO LOOKS LIKE.

















Every photo shared with the member's permission. No filters, no fake lighting, real RTB members.

WHAT ZERO CARDIO LOOKS LIKE.















Every photo shared with the member's permission. No filters, no fake lighting, real RTB members.

100+ FIVE STAR REVIEWS. HERE ARE A FEW.

5.0 ★★★★★
RTB Windsor
74 Google reviews

5.0 ★★★★★
RTB Chelsea Heights
29 Google reviews

★★★★★
"My squat, deadlift and bench numbers have gone through the roof! I love the environment, coaches and the program."
Kate, Windsor

★★★★★
"For someone who's never considered themselves sporty, this has been the best gym experience I've ever had, no exaggeration."
Veronica, Windsor

★★★★★
"I've tried F45 and BFT and never got the strength gains I've had over the past 2 months at RTB."
Judy, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"Hands down the best gym I've trained at. No cardio machines, just serious weight training and a focus on strength."
Emma, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"They've transformed my body in ways I never imagined. I was never a morning person, but now I wake up excited to train."
Buddhika, Windsor

★★★★★
"I started 2 months ago and have lost 8kgs. I now look forward to training rather than dread it."
Melissa, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"First time in my life I've stuck with working out for more than 3 weeks and actually seen results. Run, don't walk, to sign up."
Caitlyn, Windsor

★★★★★
"I've trained at BFT, F45, CrossFit and traditional gyms. You just show up and they tell you what and how to train."
Vanessa, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"I had never lifted a weight before and was really intimidated. From day one the atmosphere was welcoming and supportive."
Maddison, Windsor

★★★★★
"I even encouraged my elderly father to join, and he's now been a member for over a year."
Issey, Windsor

★★★★★
"No intimidating gym vibes. The sessions are very weights focused, which is perfect for women."
Michelle, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"Training twice a week I lost 10kg over a year, without crash dieting."
Vyvyan, Windsor

100+ FIVE STAR REVIEWS. HERE ARE A FEW.

★★★★★
"As an osteopath I send all my patients to RTB. They are great at adapting to clients with injuries."
Patrick, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"Personalised training without the cost of a 1 on 1 personal trainer. The trainers are second to none."
Callum, Windsor

★★★★★
"Whether you're a beginner or have been lifting for years, they meet you where you are."
Alice, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"I never have to push myself to attend. I always look forward to the session and I'm already seeing results."
Paul, Windsor

★★★★★
"Josh has built more than just a gym. He's built a community where everyone backs each other."
Michael, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"I have gained so much strength and changed my body shape entirely."
Danielle, Windsor

★★★★★
"The focus on pure strength training (no cardio!) is exactly what I was looking for."
Lee, Windsor

★★★★★
"Only been two weeks and I'm seeing awesome progress. FINALLY an awesome gym in Chelsea."
Stephanie, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"A training app to track progress, a body scanner and a great sense of community. RTB is my happy place."
Carolyn, Windsor

★★★★★
"Since moving out of the area I still come every week. I couldn't imagine joining anywhere else."
Mikayla, Windsor

★★★★★
"I'm new to gym classes and wish I did this years earlier."
Raymond, Chelsea Heights

★★★★★
"Can't imagine going back to cardio. I actually feel disappointed if I can't make the session."
Cassandra, Windsor

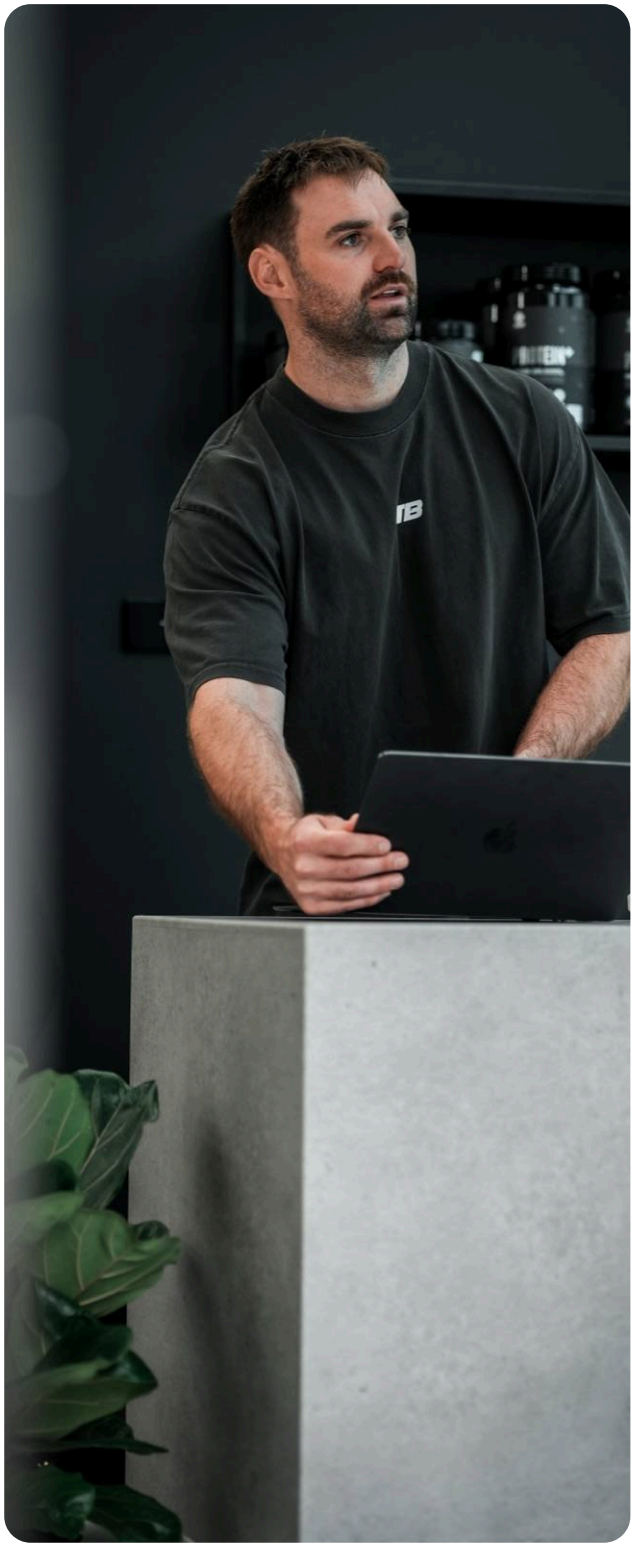
BOOK YOUR FREE CALL.

15 minutes with a coach. We work out where your body is, where it needs to be, and how to get it there. Zero risk, no lock in, no obligation to continue.

Book my free call →

rtbgym.com.au/apply

- You talk to Josh or one of the coaches, not a salesperson.
- You get a plan for your first 21 days before you ever walk in.
- If it is not for you, that is fine. You keep the plan.



Josh takes the calls himself.

RTB WINDSOR

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@rtb_windsor

RTB CHELSEA HEIGHTS

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NO CARDIO. JUST RESULTS.

SOURCES.

Every number in this guide comes from peer reviewed research. The superscripts on the science page point here.

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